ACME TECHNOLOGIES

Employee Policies & Workplace Handbook

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About This Handbook

This fictional handbook defines selected workplace policies for Acme Technologies, a fictional software company. It is created for demonstration and RAG-learning purposes only and does not represent a real company's policies.

> **RAG practice note:** The handbook uses policy IDs, departments, approval requirements, exceptions, effective dates, and repeated terminology. These features make it suitable for testing document chunking, metadata filtering, retrieval, citations, and grounded question answering.

1. General Employment Policy

Policy ID: EMP-001

Acme Technologies expects employees to perform their assigned responsibilities professionally, respectfully, and in accordance with company policies. Employees are responsible for completing required training and protecting company information.

Normal working hours for full-time employees are 9:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., Monday through Friday, with a standard one-hour lunch break. Individual teams may establish different schedules when approved by the relevant department manager.

Employees working across time zones should maintain reasonable overlap with their assigned team. Managers may define team-specific core hours when collaboration requires it.

2. Paid Time Off and Vacation

Policy ID: LEAVE-101

Full-time employees receive **20 paid vacation days per calendar year**. Vacation is intended to support rest and personal needs. Employees should request planned vacation through the employee portal at least 5 business days before the first day of leave.

Vacation requests are approved by the employee's direct manager. Approval depends on staffing requirements, project deadlines, and previously approved leave. A manager should provide a response within 3 business days.

Employees may carry forward up to **5 unused vacation days** into the next calendar year. Unused days above the 5-day carry-forward limit expire on March 31 unless an exception is approved by People Operations.

Emergency exception: When unexpected circumstances prevent advance notice, employees should notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible. Emergency leave does not automatically convert unused vacation into additional carry-forward days.

3. Sick Leave

Policy ID: LEAVE-102

Employees receive **12 paid sick days per calendar year**. Sick leave may be used for an employee's illness, medical appointments, or recovery from a short-term health condition.

Employees should notify their manager before the normal start of the workday whenever possible. A medical certificate may be requested for an absence of more than 3 consecutive working days, subject to applicable law.

4. Remote Work and Hybrid Work

Policy ID: WORK-201

Eligible full-time employees may work remotely up to **3 days per week**. Employees are expected to work from an approved location and remain available during their team's core collaboration hours.

Remote work is not an automatic entitlement. A manager may require an employee to work from the office for customer meetings, onboarding, training, security-sensitive work, or important team events.

Employees who want to work remotely from a country different from their normal employment country must obtain written approval from People Operations and the employee's manager before making travel arrangements. Cross-border remote work is limited to **30 calendar days per year** unless an executive exception is approved.

Home-office equipment: Acme provides an approved laptop and standard peripherals. Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe and secure workspace and must not allow unauthorized people to use company devices.

5. Parental Leave

Policy ID: LEAVE-201

Eligible employees may receive up to **16 weeks of paid parental leave** following the birth, adoption, or placement of a child. The policy applies regardless of the employee's gender.

Employees should notify People Operations at least 30 days before planned parental leave when reasonably possible. Unexpected events should be reported as soon as practical.

Parental leave may be taken continuously or, with manager approval, in approved blocks. Any statutory leave requirements that provide greater employee rights take precedence over this internal policy.

6. Business Travel

Policy ID: TRAVEL-301

Business travel must have a legitimate business purpose and should be approved before booking. Domestic travel requires manager approval. International travel requires approval from both the department manager and the Finance Operations team.

Employees should use the company's approved travel booking system when available. Economy-class airfare is the standard for flights under 6 hours. Business class may be approved for flights of 6 hours or longer when the employee's department head approves the request.

Hotel reimbursement is limited to the company's published city-rate allowance. Exceptions require Finance approval before the expense is incurred, except in emergencies where advance approval is not reasonably possible.

7. Expense Reimbursement

Policy ID: FIN-401

Employees may request reimbursement for reasonable business expenses incurred while performing authorized company work. Expense reports should be submitted through the expense platform within **15 calendar days** after the expense is incurred.

Receipts are required for individual expenses of **$25 or more**. If a receipt cannot be obtained, the employee must provide a written explanation and the manager must approve the exception.

Personal purchases, entertainment unrelated to business activity, traffic fines, and expenses for unauthorized companions are not reimbursable.

Approved expenses are normally reimbursed in the next available payroll cycle after Finance completes its review.

8. Information Security

Policy ID: SEC-501

Employees must protect company information, credentials, devices, and customer data. Company passwords must never be shared with another person. Multi-factor authentication is required for systems designated by the Security team.

Company laptops must use approved security software and must be locked whenever unattended. Employees must not install unapproved software that could introduce security or privacy risks.

Suspected phishing messages, lost devices, accidental data disclosures, or other security incidents must be reported to the Security team within **1 hour of discovery** whenever reasonably possible.

Remote-work security: Employees working remotely must use secure networks and should avoid handling confidential information on shared or public computers. Company devices remain subject to the same security requirements whether the employee is at home or in the office.

9. Acceptable Use of Technology

Policy ID: SEC-502

Company systems are primarily provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted when it does not interfere with work, create security risks, violate law, or consume unreasonable company resources.

Employees must not use company systems to distribute malware, attempt unauthorized access, bypass security controls, harass others, or access illegal content.

10. Confidentiality and Data Handling

Policy ID: SEC-601

Confidential information includes non-public financial data, source code, customer information, credentials, unreleased product plans, employee records, and other information designated confidential by the company.

Confidential information must only be shared with people who have a legitimate business need to access it. Employees must verify recipients before sending sensitive information by email or external collaboration tools.

Customer data must not be copied into personal cloud storage, personal email accounts, or unapproved AI tools. Approved systems listed by the Security team must be used for processing confidential company information.

11. Performance Reviews

Policy ID: PEOPLE-701

Full-time employees normally participate in a formal performance review twice per year. Reviews consider role responsibilities, goals, collaboration, quality of work, and demonstrated company values.

Managers should provide employees with written feedback and discuss development goals. Employees may submit a written response to their review within 10 business days.

12. Code of Conduct

Policy ID: ETH-801

Acme expects employees to treat colleagues, customers, partners, and candidates with professionalism and respect. Discrimination, harassment, retaliation, threats, and deliberate misuse of company resources are prohibited.

Employees who believe they have experienced or witnessed misconduct may report it to their manager, People Operations, or the confidential ethics channel. Reports made in good faith will be handled as confidentially as reasonably possible.

13. Conflict of Interest

Policy ID: ETH-802

Employees must disclose situations that could create an actual or perceived conflict between personal interests and company responsibilities. Examples include supervising a close relative, accepting significant gifts from a vendor, or making purchasing decisions involving a business in which the employee has a financial interest.

Employees should disclose potential conflicts to People Operations or their manager before participating in a related business decision. The company may establish safeguards such as reassignment of approval responsibilities.

14. Policy Exceptions and Approvals

Policy exceptions must be documented and approved by the authority specified in the relevant policy. A manager's informal verbal agreement does not automatically override a company-wide requirement.

Policy Area	Normal Approval	Exception Authority
Vacation	Direct Manager	People Operations for carry-forward exceptions
Remote Work	Direct Manager	People Operations for cross-border work; executive approval f
International Travel	Manager + Finance Operations	Department Head for exceptional airfare
Expenses	Manager + Finance review	Finance for policy exceptions
Security	Security Team	Security leadership
Parental Leave	People Operations	People Operations

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many vacation days does a full-time employee receive?
A: 20 paid vacation days per calendar year under policy LEAVE-101.

Q: How many vacation days can be carried into the next year?
A: Up to 5 unused vacation days. Amounts above 5 expire on March 31 unless People Operations approves an exception.

Q: How many days per week can eligible employees work remotely?
A: Up to 3 days per week under policy WORK-201, subject to manager approval and business requirements.

Q: Can an employee work remotely from another country?
A: Yes, but written approval from People Operations and the employee's manager is required. The normal limit is 30 calendar days per year.

Q: When must a security incident be reported?
A: Within 1 hour of discovery whenever reasonably possible.

Q: When must an expense report be submitted?
A: Within 15 calendar days after the expense is incurred.

Q: When is a receipt required for an expense?
A: For individual expenses of $25 or more.

Q: How much paid parental leave is available?
A: Up to 16 weeks for eligible employees, subject to applicable law.

16. RAG Test Questions

Use these questions after indexing the PDF. For best results, require your RAG system to cite the policy ID or source page.

1. What is the annual vacation allowance for full-time employees?

2. How many vacation days can an employee carry forward?

3. When do excess vacation days expire?

4. Who approves a normal vacation request?

5. How many remote-work days are allowed each week?

6. Can I work remotely from another country for two months?

7. What approvals are needed for international business travel?

8. When must an expense report be submitted?

9. When is a receipt required for an expense?

10. Are traffic fines reimbursable?

11. How quickly must a security incident be reported?

12. Can company data be copied into a personal cloud drive?

13. How many paid sick days are provided?

14. How much paid parental leave is available?

15. How often are formal performance reviews conducted?

16. Who can an employee contact to report misconduct?

17. Give me the policy ID for the remote-work policy.

18. Which policy covers expense reimbursement?

19. Compare the vacation policy and sick-leave policy.

20. What are the rules for cross-border remote work?

End of Handbook

This is a fictional training document created for RAG experimentation.